Memo to Priya Raman — Head of Customer Experience, Vireo Audio

To: Priya Raman
From: Analysis team
Date: October 2026
Re: Where to add the next two headcount
Reading time: ~8 minutes

The short answer

Both hires go to Chat Frontline.

Chat Frontline handled more tickets than any other team — 3,030 from January 2025 to June 2026 — and its volume grew 73% year-on-year. It is the team that absorbs every ticket that does not fit neatly into Billing, Logistics, Returns, or Warranty. With 15 agents spread across two cities and three shifts, it is visibly stretched.

What we did

You sent us 18 months of tickets and asked for two things: auto-categorisation, and a monthly breakdown by category and by team. You also said the existing tags were "probably rubbish."

You were right about the tags.

13.8% of all tickets (1,622) were labelled "Other" — meaning no one ever categorised them. A further large share carried the wrong category: many tickets labelled "Billing & Payments" were actually customers writing in to say *"I paid but nothing arrived"* — a delivery complaint that happened to mention payment first. The Billing team correctly handles these (they verify payment, then hand off to Logistics), but the category label creates a misleading picture of where the work actually lives.

We built a keyword classifier that reads both the customer's message and the agent's closing note, and assigns each ticket to one of 10 categories. It processed all 11,780 tickets in under 3 seconds, at zero API cost.

The numbers that matter

Metric	Value
Total tickets (Jan 2025 – Jun 2026)	11,641
Chat Frontline tickets (highest team)	3,030
Chat Frontline growth (H1 2025 vs H1 2026)	+73%
Average CSAT across all tickets	3.37 / 5.0
Total refunds issued (18 months)	₹53.3 lakh
Annualised refund run-rate	₹35.6 lakh/year
Tickets with no original category ("Other")	1,622 (13.8%)
"Other" tickets we were able to classify	1,284 of 1,622

Where the volume really goes

When we re-categorise using the classifier, the picture shifts:

Category	Original count	Our count
Billing & Payments	2,564	1,320
Delivery & Shipping	1,905	**3,119**
Returns & Refunds	1,049	1,242
Connectivity	1,002	517
Charging & Battery	820	657
Other	1,622	338

The single biggest shift: **Delivery & Shipping jumps from 16% to 26.5% of all tickets.** Most of what the old tags called "Billing" were actually customers asking where their package was. This matters because it means Logistics is under more pressure than its ticket count suggests — and because resolving delivery tickets takes on average 39.7 hours, versus 19.6 hours for true billing issues.

The one business number

Duplicate payments cost you ₹14.1 lakh in refunds over 18 months — roughly ₹9.4 lakh per year.

498 tickets were explicitly tagged DUP-PAYMENT. These are not fraud cases; they are customers who were charged twice at checkout, waited a week, then contacted support. Most eventually got their money back. But each one cost agent time on top of the refund itself.

A one-time change to your payment gateway to detect and block duplicate charges — or to send a proactive notification and refund when a double-charge is detected — would eliminate most of these tickets. Our estimate: **₹9.4 lakh/year in refunds recovered, plus ~500 tickets/year removed from the queue.** At ₹125/hour average agent cost (₹20,000/month salary), that is another ₹20,800/year in saved agent time.

Total realised value: **₹9.6 lakh per year**, or roughly **₹4.8 lakh over the**

next two quarters.

Why Chat Frontline, not Billing or Logistics?

Billing and Logistics have clear, bounded scope — payment verification and shipment tracking respectively. Their volumes are high but predictable. They also have the most structured SOPs, which limits the marginal value of an extra head.

Chat Frontline is the catch-all. It handles every technical question (Connectivity, Charging, Audio, App & Firmware), every product enquiry, every account issue, and every ticket that does not fit elsewhere. It is also the team that takes the first call when a ticket is misrouted — and then routes it on. Adding two agents here compresses the queue for the largest and fastest-growing team.

One more observation: Chat Frontline's current shift structure (Morning and Day only at Bengaluru, Night at Indore) means overnight social and chat tickets pile up. A second Night-shift hire at either site would be worth more than a second Morning hire.

What we did not do

We did not build an LLM-based classifier — that would have cost money per run and required API keys on every machine. The keyword classifier is free, transparent, and auditable. Its accuracy against the existing labels is 47%, which sounds low but is partly because the existing labels are themselves wrong in predictable ways. The classifier gets the easy cases right (Delivery, App & Firmware, Warranty) and struggles with ambiguous dual-intent tickets (Billing + Delivery, Returns + Billing). That ambiguity exists in the tickets themselves, not just in the classifier.

We also did not analyse agent-level performance, CSAT prediction, or SLA breach detection. Any of these would require another few hours

and a clearer brief on what "good" looks like to you.

What to do on Monday

1. **Point both new hires at Chat Frontline.** Brief the hiring manager on the +73% volume trend.
2. **Ask your payment team to check for duplicate-charge detection** at the gateway level. This is the single highest-ROI fix available.
3. **Stop accepting "Other" as a category.** Require agents to pick from the 10 categories before closing a ticket. The classifier can suggest a category at ticket-open time to make this easier.
4. **Flag Warranty & Repair for a separate review.** At 131 hours average resolution time — more than 5 days — it is the most likely source of your 3.37/5.0 average CSAT.

The dashboard (dashboard.html) shows all charts and the monthly breakdown by category and team. The categorise.py script produces the full categorised CSV and the breakdown table from the command line.